

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

BOARD ORDER NO. 6-01-25
WDID NO. 6A180020000

UPDATED WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR

U.S. ARMY - SIERRA ARMY DEPOT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL FACILITY

Lassen County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region (Regional Board) finds:

1. Discharger

The U.S. Army through Col. Nicholas R. Hurst submitted a completed report of waste discharge for the Sierra Army Depot-Wastewater Disposal Facilities on May-3, 1993. Additional information has also been subsequently submitted regarding modifications to the wastewater treatment and disposal facilities. For the purpose of this Order, the U.S. Army is referred to as the "Discharger" and the Sierra Army Depot Wastewater Disposal Facilities as the "Facility"

2. Permit History

The Regional Board originally established waste discharge requirements for the Facility under Board Order No. 6-71-23, adopted on July 19, 1971. The Regional Board updated Board Order No. 6-71-23 by adopting Board Order No. 6-84-22 on February 9, 1984.

3. Reason for Action

The Regional Board is updating WDRs as part of an ongoing program to periodically review and revise requirements to reflect current regulatory policies, and to reflect modifications and improvements which have been made to the wastewater treatment and disposal facilities.

4. Facility Location

The facility is located in portions of Section 30, T27N, R17E and Section 35, T27N, R16E, MDB&M, as shown on Attachment "A" which is made a part of this Order. The site lies within the Herlong Hydrologic Area of the Susanville Hydrologic Unit and within the Honey Lake Valley Ground Water Basin.

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5. Facility Description

The Facility consists of two wastewater treatment and disposal facilities located in two separate areas. The Cantonment Lagoons treat the majority of the wastewater flows of up to 0.160 mgd. The Warehouse Lagoons serve only the warehouse area with wastewater flows up to 0.009 mgd. Wastewater treatment is in lined stabilization ponds forming the lagoons. Treated wastewater from the Cantonment Lagoons is discharged to a constructed wetland, with seasonal overflow from the wetland to a designated percolation area. Treated wastewater from the Warehouse Lagoons is discharged to a designated percolation area. Minor and intermittent flows from other areas on the Depot are handled by septic tanks/leachfields. The population served is less than 1500 persons. When the Herlong Sanitary Cooperative completes new wastewater treatment and disposal facilities for the proposed Federal Prison, wastewater flows to the Cantonment Lagoons will be directed to the new Herlong Utilities Cooperative's wastewater treatment facilities and the Cantonment Lagoons will be abandoned.

6. Facility Capacity

The Cantonment Lagoons have a design flow-rate of 0.160 MGD. The Warehouse Lagoons have a design flow-rate of 0.009 MGD. Flows to the facility are currently at approximately 80% of capacity.

7. Authorized Disposal Areas

The designated disposal site for effluent from the Cantonment Lagoons is the constructed wetland adjacent to the lagoons, and the percolation area adjacent to the constructed wetland. The designated disposal site for effluent from the Warehouse Lagoons is the percolation area adjacent to the lagoons. These are the only authorized disposal sites for the Cantonment Lagoons and the Warehouse Lagoons.

8. Water Quality Control Plan for the Lahontan Region

The Regional Board adopted the Water Quality Control Plan for the Lahontan Region (Basin Plan) which became effective on March 31, 1995. This Order implements the Basin Plan, as amended.

9. Geology

The Facility lies in a basin-fill valley at the junction of the Sierra Nevada Province and the Modoc Plateau. The valley is bordered by the Skedaddle and Amedee mountains to the northeast, the Fort Sage and Virginia mountains to the southeast, the Diamond

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Mountains to the south and southwest, and the Shaffer and Antelope mountains to the north. The substrata at the authorized disposal sites consist of unconsolidated and semi-consolidated lacustrine and fluvial deposits of clay, silt, sand and gravel. Information is not available to determine the percolation rate. Borings indicate that the subsurface consists of silty sands, clayey sands and gravelly sands.

10. Hydrology

The Facility is located on mildly sloping terrain within an alluvial valley at an elevation of approximately 4000 feet. The annual rainfall in the area is approximately ten inches. Ephemeral drainage channels exist in the area that may be potential receiving waters for any unauthorized waste discharges. Honey Lake is located approximately four miles west and downgradient from the Facility.

11. Hydrogeology

The local groundwater flow direction follows the surface topography general northwest toward Honey Lake. The median hydraulic conductivity of the basin-fill deposits and volcanic rocks has been estimated to be approximately eight feet per day based on production test wells and descriptions of geologic materials in the basin. No monitoring wells have been installed in the vicinity of the Facility. However, from other wells in the vicinity, the depth to groundwater is estimated to be approximately 60 feet below ground surface.

12. Receiving Waters

The receiving waters are ground waters of the Honey Lake Valley Ground Water Basin (Department of Water Resources Basin No. 6-4).

13. Beneficial Uses of Ground Water

The beneficial uses of ground water in the Honey Lake Valley Ground Water Basin are:

- a. municipal and domestic supply
- b. agricultural supply
- c. industrial service supply
- d. freshwater replenishment
- e. wildlife habitat

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14. CEQA Compliance

This Order regulates the continued operation of an existing facility and as such is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) in accordance with California Code of Regulations Title 14, Chapter 3, Section 15301.

15. Notification of Interested Parties and Consideration of Written Comments

The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to update waste discharge requirements for the discharge.

16. Consideration of Public Comments

The Regional Board, in a public meeting, has heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, that the Discharger shall comply with the following:

I. DISCHARGE SPECIFICATIONS

A. Effluent Limitations

1. The monthly wastewater inflow to the Cantonment Lagoons shall not exceed 4.87 million gallons (average 0.160 MGD). The monthly wastewater inflow to the Warehouse Lagoons shall not exceed 0.28 million gallons (average 0.009 MGD).
2. All wastewater discharged to the designated disposal wetlands or disposal percolation areas shall not contain pollutants at concentrations in excess of the following limits:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Mean¹</u>	<u>Maximum</u>
BOD ²	mg/l	30	45
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	30	45

¹ The Arithmetic mean of lab results for all effluent samples collected during a period of 30 consecutive days.

² Biochemical Oxygen Demand (5 day, 20EC). Samples from oxidation ponds should be filtered (using a No. 1 Whatman filter, or equivalent) and reseeded with unfiltered sample. Other types of treatment units should analyze unfiltered samples.

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3. All wastewater discharged to the disposal wetlands or to disposal percolation areas shall have a pH of not less than 6 pH units nor more than 9 pH units. A pH over 9 is allowed if it results from a biological process within the treatment facility.
4. The effluent shall not contain trace elements, pollutants, contaminants, or combinations thereof, in concentrations which are toxic or harmful to human, plant, animal or aquatic life.

B. Receiving Water Limitations

The discharge of waste shall not cause the violation of the following water quality objectives for ground waters of the Honey Lake Valley Ground Water Basin:

1. Bacteria -The median concentration of coliform organisms over any seven-day period shall not be greater than 1.1/100 milliliters.
2. Chemical Constituents - Concentrations of chemical constituents shall not be in excess of the maximum contaminant level (MCL) or secondary maximum contaminant level (SMCL) based upon drinking water standards specified in the following provisions of Title 22 of the California Code of Regulations: Table 64431-A of Section 64431 (Inorganic Chemicals), Table 64431-B of Section 64431 (Fluoride), Table 64444-A of Section 64444 (Organic Chemicals), Table 64449-A of Section 64449 (Secondary Maximum Contaminant Levels-Consumer Acceptance Limits), and Table 64449-B of Section 64449 (Secondary Maximum Contaminant Levels-Ranges). This incorporation-by-reference is prospective including future changes to the incorporated provisions as the changes take effect. Waters shall not contain concentrations of chemical constituents in amounts that adversely affect the water for agricultural purposes or other beneficial uses.
3. Radioactivity - Concentrations of radionuclides shall not be in excess of the limits specified in Table 4 of Section 64443 (Radioactivity) of Title 22 of the California Code of Regulations. This incorporation-by-reference is prospective including future changes to the incorporated provisions as the changes take effect.
4. Taste and Odor - Concentrations of taste- or odor-producing substances shall not be in excess of concentrations that cause nuisance or that adversely affect beneficial uses. Concentrations shall not exceed adopted secondary maximum contaminant levels specified in Table 64449-A of Section 64449 (Secondary Maximum Contaminant Levels-Consumer Acceptance Limits), and Table

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64449-B of Section 64449 (Secondary Maximum Contaminant Levels-Ranges) of Title 22 of the California Code of Regulations. This incorporation-by-reference is prospective including future changes to the incorporated provisions as the changes take effect.

C. General Requirements and Prohibitions

1. There shall be no discharge, bypass or diversion of raw or partially treated sewage, sewage sludge, grease or oils from the collection, transport, treatment or disposal facilities to adjacent land areas or surface waters.
2. Surface flow or visible discharge of sewage or sewage effluent at or from the authorized disposal site to adjacent land areas or surface waters is prohibited.
3. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a pollution or a threatened pollution as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
4. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
5. The discharge of wastewater except to the authorized disposal sites is prohibited.
6. The integrity of any pond structures shall be maintained throughout the life of the ponds and shall not be diminished as the result of any maintenance or cleaning operation.

II. PROVISIONS

A. Rescission of Waste Discharge Requirements

Board Order No. 6-84-22 is hereby rescinded

B. Standard Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated September 1, 1994, in Attachment "C", which is made a Part of this Order.

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C. Monitoring and Reporting

1. Pursuant to Section 13383 and Section 13267(b) of the California Water Code, the Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 01-25 as specified by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting" dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of the Monitoring and Reporting Program.

D. Operator Certification

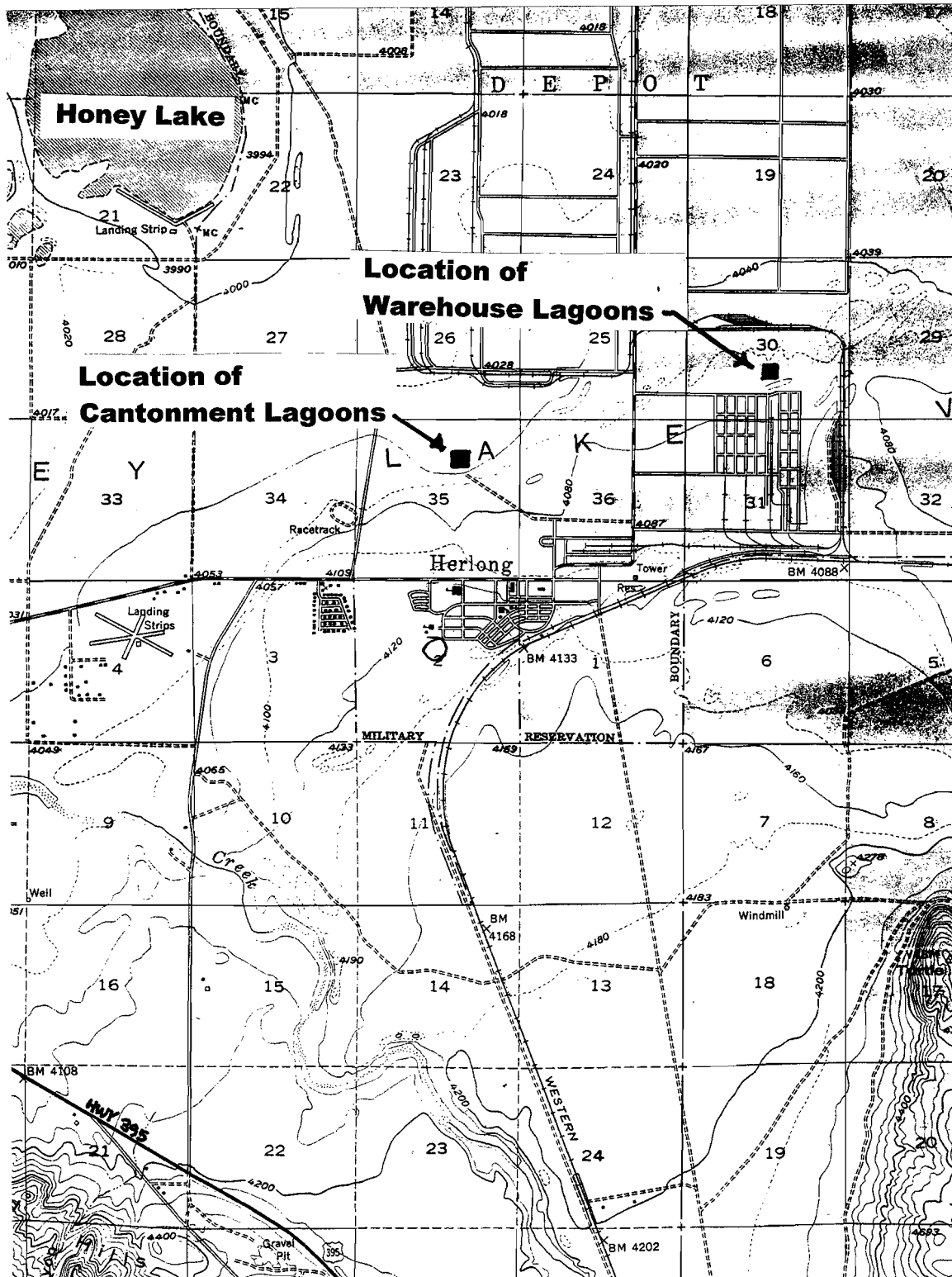
The Discharger's wastewater treatment facility shall be supervised by personnel possessing a wastewater treatment plant operator certificate of appropriate grade pursuant to *Regulations for Wastewater Treatment Plant Operator Certification and Plant Classification*, California Code of Regulations Title 23, Division 4, Chapter 14, Section 3670 et.seq.

I, Harold J. Singer, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Lahontan Region, on May 10, 2001.


HAROLD J. SINGER
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

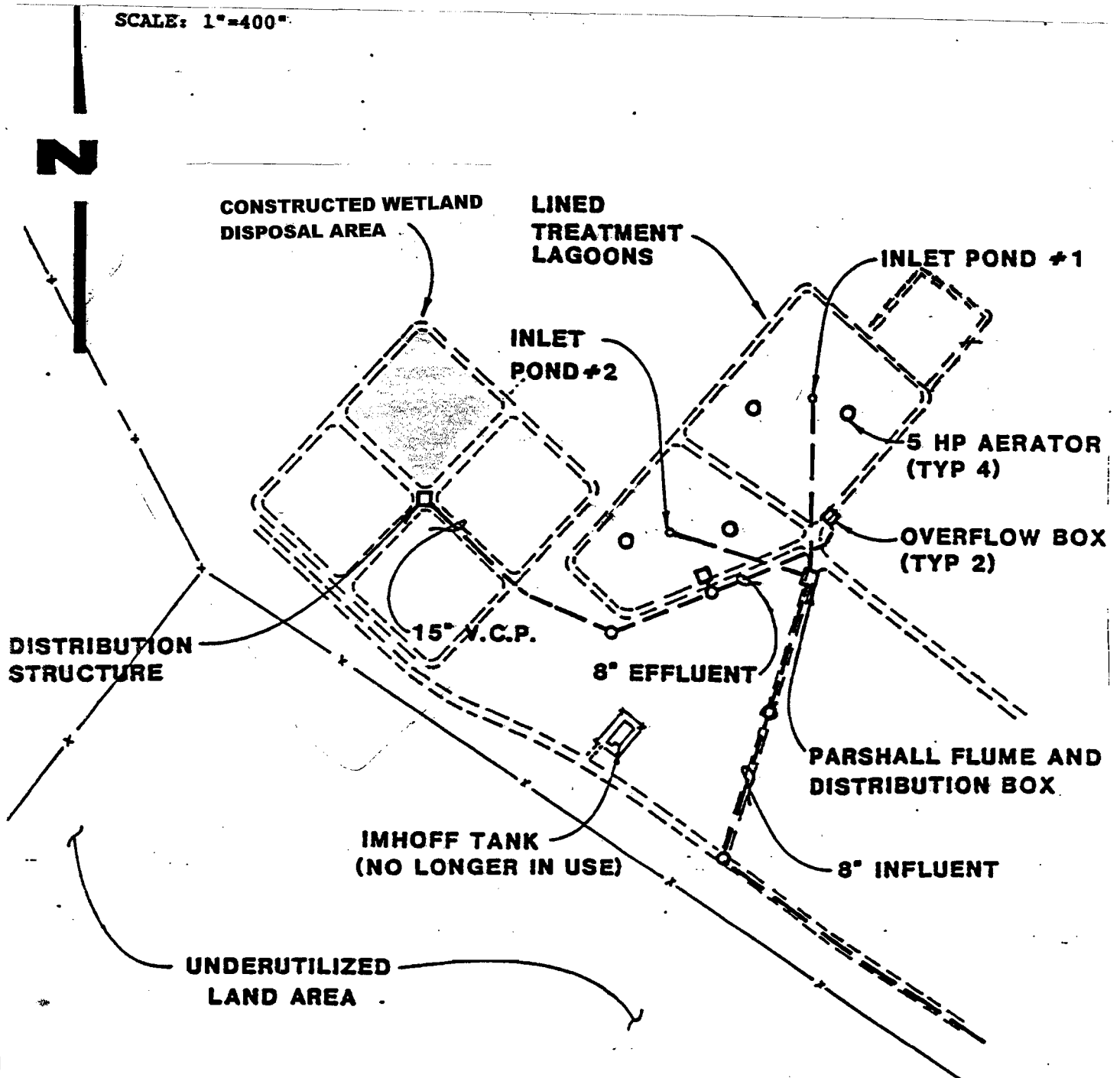
Attachments: A. Location Map
B. Existing Sewage Treatment and Disposal Facility
C. Standard Provisions for Waste Discharge Requirements

Attachment "A"
Location Map
U.S. Army Sierra Army Depot
Wastewater Treatment and Disposal Facilities



Attachment "B"
Existing Sewage Treatment and Disposal Facility
Cantonment Lagoons
U.S. Army Sierra Army Depot

SCALE: 1"=400'



ATTACHMENT "C"

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
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STANDARD PROVISIONS
FOR WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

1. Inspection and Entry

The discharger shall permit Regional Board staff:

- a. to enter upon premises in which an effluent source is located or in which any required records are kept;
- b. to copy any records relating to the discharge or relating to compliance with the waste discharge requirements;
- c. to inspect monitoring equipment or records; and
- d. to sample any discharge.

2. Reporting Requirements

- a. Pursuant to California Water Code 13267(b), the discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board by telephone whenever an adverse condition occurred as a result of this discharge; written confirmation shall follow within two weeks. An adverse condition includes, but is not limited to, spills of petroleum products or toxic chemicals, or damage to control facilities that could affect compliance.
- b. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260 (c), any proposed material change in the character of the waste, manner or method of treatment or disposal, increase of discharge, or location of discharge, shall be reported to the Regional Board at least 120 days in advance of implementation of any such proposal. This shall include, but not be limited to, all significant soil disturbances.
- c. The owner(s) of, and discharger upon, property subject to waste discharge requirements shall be considered to have a continuing responsibility for ensuring compliance with applicable waste discharge requirements in the operations or use of the owned property. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13260(c), any change in the ownership and/or operation of property subject to the waste discharge requirements shall be reported to the Regional Board. Notification of applicable waste discharge requirements shall be furnished in writing to the new owners and/or operators and a copy of such notification shall be sent to the Regional Board.
- d. If a discharger becomes aware that any information submitted to the Regional Board is incorrect, the discharger shall immediately notify the Regional Board, in writing, and correct that information.

- e. Reports required by the waste discharge requirements, and other information requested by the Regional Board, must be signed by a duly authorized representative of the discharger. Under Section 13268 of the California Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1000) for each day of violation.
- f. If the discharger becomes aware that their waste discharge requirements are no longer needed (because the project will not be built or the discharge will cease) the discharger shall notify the Regional Board in writing and request that their waste discharge requirements be rescinded.

3. Right to Revise Waste Discharge Requirements

The Board reserves the privilege of changing all or any portion of the waste discharge requirements upon legal notice to and after opportunity to be heard is given to all concerned parties.

4. Duty to Comply

Failure to comply with the waste discharge requirements may constitute a violation of the California Water Code and is grounds for enforcement action or for permit termination, revocation and reissuance, or modification.

5. Duty to Mitigate

The discharger shall take all reasonable steps to minimize or prevent any discharge in violation of the waste discharge requirements which has a reasonable likelihood of adversely affecting human health or the environment.

6. Proper Operation and Maintenance

The discharger shall at all times properly operate and maintain all facilities and systems of treatment and control (and related appurtenances) that are installed or used by the discharger to achieve compliance with the waste discharge requirements. Proper operation and maintenance includes adequate laboratory control, where appropriate, and appropriate quality assurance procedures. This provision requires the operation of backup or auxiliary facilities or similar systems that are installed by the discharger, when necessary to achieve compliance with the conditions of the waste discharge requirements.

7. Waste Discharge Requirement Actions

The waste discharge requirements may be modified, revoked and reissued, or terminated for cause. The filing of a request by the discharger for waste discharge requirement modification, revocation and reissuance, termination, or a notification of planned changes

or anticipated noncompliance, does not stay any of the waste discharge requirements conditions.

8. Property Rights

The waste discharge requirements do not convey any property rights of any sort, or any exclusive privileges, nor does it authorize any injury to private property or any invasion of personal rights, nor any infringement of federal, state or local laws or regulations.

9. Enforcement

The California Water Code provides for civil liability and criminal penalties for violations or threatened violations of the waste discharge requirements including imposition of civil liability or referral to the Attorney General.

10. Availability

A copy of the waste discharge requirements shall kept and maintained by the discharger and be available at all times to operating personnel.

11. Severability

Provisions of the waste discharge requirements are severable. If any provision of the requirements is found invalid, the remainder of the requirements shall not be affected.

12. Public Access

General public access shall be effectively excluded from treatment and disposal facilities.

13. Transfers

Providing there is no material change in the operation of the facility, this Order may be transferred to a new owner or operation. The owner/operator must request the transfer in writing and receive written approval from the Regional Board Executive Officer.

14. Definitions

- a. "Surface waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, live streams, either perennial or ephemeral, which flow in natural or artificial water courses and natural lakes and artificial impoundments of waters. "Surface waters" does not include artificial water courses or impoundments used exclusively for wastewater disposal.
- b. "Ground waters" as used in this Order, include, but are not limited to, all subsurface waters being above atmospheric pressure and the capillary fringe of these waters.

15. Storm Protection

All facilities used for collection, transport, treatment, storage, or disposal of waste shall be adequately protected against overflow, washout, inundation, structural damage or a significant reduction in efficiency resulting from a storm or flood having a recurrence interval of once in 100 years.

ShT:Forms/WDR Standard Provisions

2. OPERATIONAL REQUIREMENTS

a. Sample Results

Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), the discharger shall maintain all sampling and analytical results including: date, exact place, and time of sampling; date analyses were performed; sample collector's name; analyst's name; analytical techniques used; and results of all analyses. Such records shall be retained for a minimum of three years. This period of retention shall be extended during the course of any unresolved litigation regarding this discharge, or when requested by the Regional Board.

b. Operational Log

Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), an operation and maintenance log shall be maintained at the facility. All monitoring and reporting data shall be recorded in a permanent log book.

3. REPORTING

a. For every item where the requirements are not met, the discharger shall submit a statement of the actions undertaken or proposed which will bring the discharge into full compliance with requirements at the earliest time, and shall submit a timetable for correction.

b. Pursuant to California Water Code Section 13267(b), all sampling and analytical results shall be made available to the Regional Board upon request. Results shall be retained for a minimum of three years. This period of retention shall be extended during the course of any unresolved litigation regarding this discharge, or when requested by the Regional Board.

c. The discharger shall provide a brief summary of any operational problems and maintenance activities to the Board with each monitoring report. Any modifications or additions to, or any major maintenance conducted on, or any major problems occurring to the wastewater conveyance system, treatment facilities, or disposal facilities shall be included in this summary.

d. Monitoring reports shall be signed by:

i. In the case of a corporation, by a principal executive officer at least of the level of vice-president or his duly authorized representative, if such representative is responsible for the overall operation of the facility from which the discharge originates;

ii. In the case of a partnership, by a general partner;

iii. In the case of a sole proprietorship, by the proprietor; or

- iv. In the case of a municipal, state or other public facility, by either a principal executive officer, ranking elected official, or other duly authorized employee.
- e. Monitoring reports are to include the following:
 - i. Name and telephone number of individual who can answer questions about the report.
 - ii. The Monitoring and Reporting Program Number.
 - iii. WDID Number.
- f. Modifications

This Monitoring and Reporting Program may be modified at the discretion of the Regional Board Executive Officer.

4. NONCOMPLIANCE

Under Section 13268 of the Water Code, any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring reports, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in an amount of up to one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day of violation.

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 01-25
WDID NO. 6A180020000

FOR

SIERRA ARMY DEPOT WASTEWATER DISPOSAL FACILITIES

Lassen County

I. MONITORING

A. Flow Monitoring

The Discharger shall monitor and record, for each day, the total influent flow to the Cantonment Lagoons and to the Warehouse Lagoons. A monthly total shall be computed at the end of each month.

B. Effluent Monitoring

Grab samples of effluent shall be collected from the outflow of the Cantonment Lagoons prior to its discharge to the constructed wetlands on a quarterly basis, during the months of March, June, September and December. The samples shall be analyzed for the following constituents:

<u>Parameter</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Minimum Reporting Limit</u>
5-day BOD	mg/l	5 mg/l
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	10 mg/l

C. Inspections of Disposal Area

The Discharger shall conduct an inspection of the treatment facilities and of each wastewater disposal area (the constructed wetlands adjacent to the Cantonment Lagoons, the percolation area adjacent to the Warehouse Lagoons and each septic tank/leachfield site) on a quarterly basis and note the following:

- a. Damage to containment facilities
- b. Overgrowth by weeds which hamper the facility's operation
- c. Nuisance odors.
- d. Nuisance insect vectors.
- e. Adequate access controls
- f. Colors, scums, unusual odors, foams which indicate improper operation of the facility.
- g. Daylighting of sewage in leachfields.
- h. Heavy accumulations of waste sludge.
- i. Indications of high ground water in the area of the facilities.
- j. Proper operation and calibration of all flow measuring devices

- k. Development and health of vegetation in constructed disposal wetlands.
- l. Period of overflow (number of days) from constructed disposal wetlands
- m. Estimated daily volume of overflow from constructed disposal wetlands

II. REPORTING

A. General Provisions

The Discharger shall comply with the "General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting," dated September 1, 1994, which is attached to and made part of this Monitoring and Reporting Program.

B. Notation of Noncompliance

The Discharger shall note and explain in each monitoring report any unusual occurrence such as any system failure that could affect water quality or noncompliance with any waste discharge requirement, effluent limitation, or receiving water limitation. This notation shall be included in a cover letter that is part of each monitoring report submitted.

C. Submittal Periods

Monitoring reports shall be submitted quarterly not later than January 15, April 15, July 15 and October 15 for the previous quarter. The data shall be arranged to show a tabular and/or graphical presentation of the monitoring data obtained for the monitoring period, and shall include total flows for each month.

Ordered by: Harold J. Singer
HAROLD J. SINGER
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Dated: May 10, 2001

Attachments: General Provisions for Monitoring and Reporting

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
LAHONTAN REGION

GENERAL PROVISIONS
FOR MONITORING AND REPORTING

1. **SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS**

- a. All analyses shall be performed in accordance with the current edition(s) of the following documents:
 - i. *Standard Methods for the Examination of Water and Wastewater*
 - ii. *Methods for Chemical Analysis of Water and Wastes, EPA*
- b. All analyses shall be performed in a laboratory certified to perform such analyses by the California State Department of Health Services or a laboratory approved by the Regional Board Executive Officer. Specific methods of analysis must be identified on each laboratory report.
- c. Any modifications to the above methods to eliminate known interferences shall be reported with the sample results. The methods used shall also be reported. If methods other than EPA-approved methods or Standard Methods are used, the exact methodology must be submitted for review and must be approved by the Regional Board Executive Officer prior to use.
- d. The discharger shall establish chain-of-custody procedures to insure that specific individuals are responsible for sample integrity from commencement of sample collection through delivery to an approved laboratory. Sample collection, storage, and analysis shall be conducted in accordance with an approved Sampling and Analysis Plan (SAP). The most recent version of the approved SAP shall be kept at the facility.
- e. The discharger shall calibrate and perform maintenance procedures on all monitoring instruments and equipment to ensure accuracy of measurements, or shall insure that both activities will be conducted. The calibration of any wastewater flow measuring device shall be recorded and maintained in the permanent log book described in 2.b, below.
- f. A grab sample is defined as an individual sample collected in fewer than 15 minutes.
- g. A composite sample is defined as a combination of no fewer than eight individual samples obtained over the specified sampling period at equal intervals. The volume of each individual sample shall be proportional to the discharge flow rate at the time of sampling. The sampling period shall equal the discharge period, or 24 hours, whichever period is shorter.